

Event Information:

☆ As of August 2022, APT35 aka Charming Kitten was observed using a new tool called Hyperscrape to extract emails from their victims' mailboxes

EventID :

212

Event Time :

Dec, 27, 2023, 11:22 AM

Rule :

SOC250 - APT35 HyperScape Data Exfiltration Tool Detected

Level :

Security Analyst

Hostname :

Arthur

Ip Address :

172.16.17.72

Process Name :

EmailDownloader.exe

Process Path :

C:\Users\LetsDefend\Downloads>EmailDownloader.exe

Parent Process :

C:\Windows\Explorer.EXE

Command Line :

C:\Users\LetsDefend\Downloads>EmailDownloader.exe

File Hash :

cd2ba296828660ecd07a36e8931b851dda0802069ed926b3161745aae9aa6daa

Trigger Reason :

Unusual or suspicious patterns of behavior linked to the hash have been identified, indicating potential malicious intent.

Device Action :

Allowed

Analysis Steps:

Logs were searched with IP 172[.]16.17.72 (Arthur) as the source in the relevant time-frame yielding 2 events. The first event shows a successful windows RPD logon event from 173[.]209.51.54.

The screenshot shows a security log search interface. At the top, a search bar contains the text "Source Address contains '172.16.17.72'" and a search icon. Below the search bar, it indicates "2 events (before Dec, 27, 2023, 11:22 AM UTC)". A table of results is displayed, showing details for a single event. The table has columns for "type", "source_address", "source_port", "destination_address", "destination_port", "time", and "Raw Log". The event details are as follows:

Field	Value
type	OS
source_address	172.16.17.72
source_port	0
destination_address	172.16.17.72
destination_port	0
time	Dec, 27, 2023, 11:17 AM
Raw Log	
Username	Arthur
EventID	4624(An account was successfully logged on)
Logon Type	10
Source IP	173.209.51.54

At the bottom of the table, it says "1 row selected".

The following event shows the file in question being downloaded from 136[.]243.108.14 and that this was successfully allowed through the Firewall.

Source Address contains "172.16.17.72"

All Time

2 events (before Dec, 27, 2023, 11:22 AM UTC)

< 1 >

< Hide Fields

INTERESTING FIELDS

α type

α source_address

source_port

α destination_address

destination_port

α raw_log

① | Event

source_address	172.16.17.72
source_port	24234
destination_address	136.243.108.14
destination_port	80
time	Dec, 27, 2023, 11:22 AM
Raw Log	
Source IP	172.16.17.72
Destination IP	136.243.108.14
Destination Port	80
Source Process	EmailDownloader.exe
Firewall Action	SUCCESS

1 row selected

The downloaded file is listed as malicious by 49/67 Vendors on VirusTotal. Under the category of Trojan with subcategories such as Spyware and Ransomware as of 10 days ago.

49

147

Community Score

49/57 security vendors flagged this file as malicious

cf3b2796328660ec807a3fe0931b831dda082067e0d2f03101145aae7a6fdaa

EmailDownloader.exe

peexe

checks-network-adapters

malware

detect-debug-environment

overlay

direct-cpu-clock-access

assembly

runtime-modules

Size

142.54 KB

Last Analysis Date

10 days ago

Report

Export

DETECTION

DETAILS

RELATIONS

BEHAVIOR

COMMUNITY 10

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Threat label

trojan.msi/hyperscript

Threat categories

trojan ransomware spyware

Family labels

msi hyperscript bladi-bind

Security vendors' analysis

Do you want to automate checks?

AhnLab-V3	Malware/GenRL_Reputation.C4327870	AICloud	Trojan/Stealer.JSOL_HyperScript.Gen
ALYac	Trojan.Email.Downloader.A	Antiy-AVL	Trojan/APT1/Win32.APT35
Arcabit	Trojan.Generic.D236FFEB	Arctic Wolf	Unsafe
Avast	Win32:MalwareX-gen [Misc]	AVG	Win32:MalwareX-gen [Misc]
Avira (no cloud)	TR/W32.Agent	BitDefender	Trojan.Generic.37158991

When analysing the device it can be confirmed that this suspicious file was executed and is actively running.

EVENT TIME	PROCESS ID	PROCESS NAME	PARENT PROCESS	COMMAND LINE
2023-12-27 11:21:15.042	6312	explorer.exe	userinit.exe	C:\Windows\...
2023-12-27 11:21:37.051	6315	EmailDownl...	explorer.exe	C:\Users\Lets...
Event Time : 2023-12-27 11:21:37.051 Process ID : 6315 Target Process Command Line : C:\Users\LetsDefend\Downloads\EmailDownloader.exe Image Path : C:\Users\LetsDefend\Downloads\EmailDownloader.exe Process User : EC2AMAZ-ILGVOIN\Arthur Parent Name : explorer.exe Parent Path : C:\Windows\explorer.exe Command Line : C:\Users\LetsDefend\Downloads\EmailDownloader.exe				

The IP that accessed the endpoint via RPD is in our CTI database and associated with Charming Kitten (APT35).

DATE	DATA TYPE	DATA	TAG	DATA SOURCE
Dec, 28, 2023, 10:50 AM	IP	173.209.51.54	APT35,Charmi...	Anonymous

The IP is external to the organisation. No emails have been received indicating penetration testing involving the IP for the relevant time period. VirusTotal indicates it is a Canadian address associated with 173.[.]209.51.54 AS 36666 (GloboTech Communications). 3/91 security vendors flagged this IP address as malicious.

3

Community Score

3/91 security vendors flagged this IP address as malicious

173.209.51.54 (173.209.32.0/19)
AS 36666 (GloboTech Communications)

CA Last Analysis Date: 2 days ago

Reanalyze More

DETECTION

DETAILS

RELATIONS

COMMUNITY

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Security vendors' analysis

Do you want to automate checks?

Chong Lua Dao	Malicious	Forcepoint ThreatSeeker	Malicious
SOCradar	Phishing	alphaMountain.ai	Suspicious
Abusix	Clean	Acronis	Clean
ADMINUSLabs	Clean	AILabs (MONITORAPP)	Clean

On AbuseIPDB this IP was reported 1 time with a 0% confidence of abuse.

173.209.51.54 was found in our database!

This IP was reported 1 times. Confidence of Abuse is 0%: 0%

ISP

GloboTech Communications

Usage Type

Data Center/Web Hosting/Transit

ASN

AS36666

Domain Name

globo.tech

Country

 Canada

City

Montreal, Quebec

The malware hosting IP is in our CTI database and is associated with Charming Kitten as well.

DATE	DATA TYPE	DATA	TAG	DATA SOURCE
Dec, 28, 2023, 10:50 AM	IP	136.243.108.14	APT35,Charmi...	Anonymous

The IP is external to the organisation. No emails have been received indicating penetration testing involving the IP for the relevant time period. VirusTotal indicates it is a German address associated with 36[.]243.108.14 AS 24940 (Hetzner Online GmbH). 15/91 security vendors flagged this IP address as malicious as of 4 days ago.

15 / 91

Community Score

15/91 security vendors flagged this IP address as malicious

136.243.108.14 (136.243.0.0/16)
AS 24940 (Hetzner Online GmbH)

DE Last Analysis Date
4 days ago

Reanalyze More

DETECTIONDETAILSRELATIONSCOMMUNITY11

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Security vendors' analysis

ADMINUSLabs	Malicious	alphaMountain.ai	Malicious
Antiy-AVL	Malicious	BitDefender	Phishing
Chong Lua Dao	Malicious	CyRadard	Malicious
Dr.Web	Malicious	Forcepoint ThreatSeeker	Malicious
Fortinet	Malware	G-Data	Phishing
Kaspersky	Malware	Lionic	Malicious
SOCiRadar	Phishing	VIPRE	Malware

Do you want to automate checks?

On AbuseIPDB this IP was reported 1 time with a 0% confidence of abuse.

136.243.108.14 was found in our database!

This IP was reported 1 times. Confidence of Abuse is 0%: 0%

ISP

Hetzner Online GmbH

Usage Type

Data Center/Web Hosting/Transit

ASN

[AS24940](#)

Hostname(s)

smtp11.smtplab.com

Domain Name

hetzner.de

Country

Germany

City

Falkenstein, Saxony

Based on following Playbook procedure and the analysis of available information, this alert is determined to be a successful True Positive.

Report:

Incident Summary

Analysis confirms a True Positive compromise of the endpoint Arthur (172[.]16.17.72) by the threat actor Charming Kitten (APT35). The attacker gained initial access via an unauthorised RDP session, subsequently downloading and executing the HyperScape data exfiltration tool (EmailDownloader.exe) to extract contents from the victim's mailbox.

Incident Details

- **Alert Name:** SOC250 - APT35 HyperScape Data Exfiltration Tool Detected
- **Target Host:** Arthur (172[.]16.17.72)
- **Attacker Initial IP:** 173[.]209.51.54
- **Device Action:** Allowed

Analysis and Evidence

- **Initial Access:** Log Management reveals a successful Windows RDP logon (Event ID 4624, Logon Type 10) originating from the external IP 173[.]209.51.54 at 11:17 AM.
- **Payload Delivery:** At 11:22 AM, the compromised host successfully downloaded EmailDownloader.exe from 136[.]243.108.14 over port 80.
- **Execution:** Endpoint processes confirm EmailDownloader.exe (PID 6315) was successfully executed by the user Arthur from the C:\Users\LetsDefend\Downloads\ directory.

Threat Intelligence

- **OSINT (Infrastructure):** The RDP source IP (173[.]209.51.54) is located in Canada (GloboTech Communications), and the payload hosting IP (136[.]243.108.14) is located in Germany (Hetzner Online GmbH).
- **Reputation:** Both IP addresses are explicitly tagged in the internal CTI database as belonging to Charming Kitten (APT35). The downloaded file hash is highly malicious, flagged by 49/67 vendors on VirusTotal as a Trojan/Spyware.

Actions Taken

1. Analysed RDP logs to identify the initial access vector used by the threat actor.
2. Verified the subsequent download and execution of the HyperScape (EmailDownloader.exe) malware.
3. Investigated the attacker infrastructure, confirming attribution to APT35.
4. Isolated the device from the network to prevent further data exfiltration.
5. Declared the alert a True Positive and escalated.

Let's Defend Result

SOC250 - APT35 HyperScape Data Exfiltration Tool Detected

True Positive (+5 Point)

Containment (+5 Point)

Determine the Scope (+5 Point)

IP Reputation Check (+5 Point)

Attacker IP Analysis (+5 Point)

Determine the Type of Reconnaissance (+5 Point)